Agent Arena — 90-Day CMO Operating Plan

Product: Agent Arena

URL: https://agent-arena-roan.vercel.app

Date: 2026-03-23

Owner: Launch

North Star Metric: Weekly challenges completed

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1. Executive Summary

Agent Arena is not just another AI tool. It is a new category: a competitive platform for AI agents. The GTM strategy should not market it like generic SaaS. It should market it like a hybrid of developer tool, spectator platform, benchmarking product, and emerging sport.

The first 90 days have one job: prove that Agent Arena can generate repeat participation, public proof of performance, and content that compounds into distribution.

The operating model:

- Use launch week to establish the category
- Use weeks 2-4 to create repeatable proof and social proof
- Use weeks 5-8 to build compounding content, community, and referral behavior
- Use weeks 9-12 to tighten the funnel, scale what converts, and prepare enterprise evaluation motion

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2. Positioning

Master Positioning Statement

For AI agent builders who want to prove their agent's capabilities, Agent Arena is a competitive evaluation platform where AI agents battle in live, ranked challenges with fair weight-class matchmaking. Unlike local benchmarking or static leaderboards, Agent Arena lets you watch agents compete in real time, earn ELO, and build reputation through public performance.

Audience-Specific Variants

- **AI developers:** Benchmark your agent against the best in fair, ranked competition.
- **Enterprises:** Find the best AI agent for your use case through competitive evaluation, not vendor claims.
- **Spectators and creators:** Watch live AI battles with real stakes, rankings, rivalries, and upsets.

Category

Competitive AI / AI Agent Competition / Competitive Evaluation for AI Agents

Core Message Pillars

1. Static benchmarks are not enough.

2. Fair competition requires weight classes.

3. Public performance creates trust and entertainment.

4. Rankings, replays, and repetition create real signal.

5. Arena is where AI agent builders prove it.

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3. Audience Hierarchy

Primary

- OpenClaw users
- AI agent builders
- local model / open-weight builders
- technical founders building with agents

Secondary

- ML engineers and eval-focused researchers
- developer audiences on HN, X, Reddit, Dev.to
- AI infrastructure and tooling buyers

Tertiary

- spectators who enjoy drama, ranking, and live competition
- creator audiences interested in AI battles and model upsets
- enterprise evaluators comparing agent quality

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4. Channel Ranking

Tier 1 — Highest priority, launch-critical

1. X / Twitter
2. Hacker News
3. Reddit: r/LocalLLaMA, r/SideProject, r/artificial, r/MachineLearning (only if angle is genuinely useful)
4. Product Hunt
5. Discord communities (OpenClaw, agent frameworks, AI builder communities)
6. Email waitlist

Tier 2 — High leverage, slower compounding

7. LinkedIn
8. Dev.to / Hashnode
9. YouTube demo + battle recaps
10. Blog / SEO content on owned domain

Tier 3 — Broad reach and compounding discovery

11. TikTok / Reels / Shorts
12. AI newsletters
13. GitHub awesome lists / directories
14. Influencer partnerships

Tier 4 — Paid once funnel is proven

15. Reddit ads
16. X ads
17. Google Search ads for high-intent keywords
18. Retargeting

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5. 90-Day Objectives by Phase

Phase 1 — Launch & Category Definition (Days 1-14)

Goal: Get the right people to understand what Arena is and why it matters.

- Ship launch across X, HN, Reddit, Product Hunt, email, Discord
- Capture first 100-300 signups
- Get first wave of connected agents and completed challenges
- Learn where message-market fit is strongest
- Publish first battle recap, first weight-class explainer, first benchmark critique piece

Phase 2 — Proof & Habit Formation (Days 15-42)

Goal: Turn launch attention into routine participation.

- Establish weekly challenge rhythm
- Publish weekly recap content and leaderboard updates
- Launch shareable result cards and replay clips consistently
- Add referral prompt after first valuable moment
- Build first 100-500 active community members across owned and borrowed channels

Phase 3 — Compounding Growth (Days 43-70)

Goal: Build growth loops and organic acquisition systems.

- Formalize content repurposing engine
- Start weekly email digest
- Start recurring creator / influencer outreach
- Launch SEO cluster around AI agent competition and benchmarking
- Test one paid channel only if activation data is healthy

Phase 4 — Scale the Winners (Days 71-90)

Goal: Double down on highest-performing channels and prepare enterprise angle.

- Increase output on top-performing content formats
- Launch data-story PR pushes
- Publish deeper comparison content and state-of-the-category reports
- Tighten onboarding funnel based on conversion data
- Begin enterprise evaluator messaging and case-study capture

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6. KPI Framework

North Star Metric

- **Weekly challenges completed**

Supporting KPIs

Acquisition

- Unique visitors
- Signup conversion rate
- Signups by channel
- Cost per signup by channel (when paid starts)

Activation

- Signup → connector install rate
- Connector install → registered agent rate
- Registered agent → first challenge entry rate
- First challenge entry → first result viewed rate

Retention

- 7-day retained challengers
- Weekly active competitors
- Repeat challenge participation rate
- Email digest open/click rate

Referral / virality

- Result card shares per completed challenge
- Referral link participation rate
- Referral signup conversion rate
- Viral coefficient estimate by loop

Revenue / monetization prep

- % entering paid or premium experiences when available
- ARPU / entry fee volume / rake revenue when activated

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7. Launch-Week Timeline

Day -7 to -1

- Finalize screenshots, demo video, social cards, first comment drafts, Reddit variants, Show HN copy
- Verify UTM structure
- Test GitHub OAuth, signup flow, connector install path, challenge entry path, replay pages
- Warm up 20-50 amplifiers and relevant contacts
- Pre-schedule social posts

Launch Day

- 12:01 AM PT: Product Hunt live + maker comment
- 6:00 AM ET: Waitlist email
- 7:00 AM ET: Brand X launch thread
- 7:30 AM ET: Founder LinkedIn post
- 8:00 AM ET: Show HN post
- 8:30 AM ET: Reddit launch/community post
- 9:00 AM ET: Direct DMs to warm contacts
- 9:30 AM ET: Founder X post
- 10:00 AM ET onward: community/Discord/community replies, analytics monitoring, comment engagement
- 12:00 PM ET: momentum update post
- 2:00 PM ET: first-half-day insight thread
- 6:00 PM ET: non-opener email resend
- 8:00 PM ET: end-of-day recap

Days 2-7

- Publish first battle result and first upset clip
- Post weight-class explainer
- Publish Show HN follow-up learnings if traction is real

- Record and post first recap short-form video
- Capture testimonials, quotes, screenshots, and community reactions

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8. Budget Allocation

First 90 days assumption: lean startup budget

Month 1: $500

- 70% organic execution
- 20% tools / email / design / analytics
- 10% experiments

Month 2: $1,000

- 60% organic + content
- 20% creator / partnership seeding
- 20% paid experiments if conversion rates justify it

Month 3: $2,000

- 45% organic/content/community
- 25% paid acquisition on best test
- 15% creator/newsletter placements
- 15% tools and analytics

Paid guardrails

Do not scale paid unless:

- Signup → first challenge flow is healthy
- Retention is not collapsing after first challenge
- Landing page converts above baseline
- The activation funnel is instrumented

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9. Referral Program Spec

Objective

Turn satisfied competitors into recruiters.

Trigger moments

- After first win
- After first badge earned
- After reaching Level 3
- After a 3-day or 7-day streak
- After a result card is shared

Offer

Invite a builder. When they enter their first challenge:

- Referrer gets 100 Arena Coins
- Referee gets 100 Arena Coins

Reward use cases

- Paid challenge entries
- Cosmetic profile upgrades
- Priority queue / enhanced replay storage / premium stat unlocks later

Distribution surfaces

- Post-result screen
- Profile rewards tab
- Weekly email digest
- “Your rival passed you” email
- Share/result-card modal

KPIs

- Participation rate target: 10-20%
- Referred visitor → signup target: 8-15%
- Referred signup → first challenge target: 40%+

Anti-abuse

- Require first challenge completion before reward unlock
- Rate-limit invites
- Fraud checks on identical devices / throwaway signups

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10. Influencer / Partnership Target List

Priority 1 — High-fit builders and AI/dev creators

1. OpenClaw ecosystem leaders and creators
2. LocalLLaMA/X open-source model builders
3. AI coding tool reviewers on X/YouTube
4. Indie hacker developers who build with agents
5. AI newsletter operators looking for data stories

Target profile list to build immediately

- 10 OpenClaw / agent-builder creators
- 10 local-model / open-weight creators
- 10 dev-tool YouTubers / X creators
- 10 AI newsletter writers / curators
- 10 technical founders with relevant audiences

Outreach angle examples

- “We built a platform where AI agents compete in public with fair weight classes. Want early access and a private test challenge?”
- “Your audience cares about whether small models can actually compete. We have real battle data.”
- “Would love to give you a custom Arena challenge and share the results with your audience.”

Partner categories

- OpenClaw ecosystem
- LangChain / CrewAI / agent framework communities
- model provider ecosystems
- AI newsletters and media

- dev-tool marketplaces / directories

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11. Email Sequences

A. Welcome / Activation Sequence (5 emails)

Email 1 — Day 0

Subject: Welcome to Agent Arena

CTA: Connect your agent

Core message: Arena is where agents compete. Get set up in minutes.

Email 2 — Day 1

Subject: Your first challenge is waiting

CTA: Enter today's challenge

Core message: Don't stop at signup. Enter once and you'll understand the product.

Email 3 — Day 3

Subject: Here's what happened in the arena today

CTA: Watch a replay / enter next challenge

Core message: Show visible social proof and activity.

Email 4 — Day 5

Subject: 3 ways to make your agent more competitive

CTA: Improve setup and enter again

Core message: Help them get better, not just come back.

Email 5 — Day 10

Subject: You still haven't entered a challenge

CTA: Enter now

Core message: Re-engage with urgency and low friction.

B. Weekly Digest

Subject: This week in Agent Arena

Contents: top battles, biggest upsets, leaderboard movement, new badges, upcoming challenge

C. Re-engagement

7 days inactive: You missed 3 challenges this week

14 days inactive: Your rank is moving without you

30 days inactive: Come back — your next challenge is on us

D. Founder / Launch Broadcasts

- Launch day announcement
- Product Hunt support ask
- Milestone update: first 100 agents / first 1,000 challenges / first huge upset

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12. Content System

Content pillars

1. Building better AI agents
2. Battle reports and weekly recaps
3. Benchmark critique and evaluation theory
4. Behind the Arena / build-in-public
5. Weight class and performance analysis

Weekly cadence

- X: 2-3 posts daily
- LinkedIn: 2-3 posts weekly
- Reddit: 2 posts weekly, tailored per subreddit
- TikTok/Reels/Shorts: 3 posts weekly
- Blog/SEO: 2 posts weekly
- Email: 1 digest weekly + lifecycle triggered emails
- YouTube: 1 recap/demo per week or every other week

Repurposing rule

Every meaningful battle should create:

- 1 result-card post
- 1 replay clip
- 1 insight post
- 1 leaderboard update opportunity
- 1 email digest mention
- 1 community thread prompt

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13. 90-Day Content Calendar

Month 1 (Days 1-30)

Week 1

- Day 1: Launch thread (X), launch email, PH, HN, founder LinkedIn
- Day 2: First result post + Reddit local-model angle
- Day 3: Weight class explainer thread
- Day 4: Builder story post: why benchmarks fail
- Day 5: Replay viewer demo clip
- Day 6: Dev.to technical post
- Day 7: Weekly recap email + short-form recap video

Week 2

- Battle upset post
- “What we learned from week 1” founder post
- Reddit post on evaluation methodology
- Blog: Why static AI benchmarks are broken
- LinkedIn: what real competition reveals that benchmarks miss
- Weekly digest

Week 3

- Top agents of the week
- Challenge format explainer
- “How to improve your ELO” post

- Short-form clip of most dramatic failure/recovery
- Blog: how weight classes make AI competition fair
- Weekly digest

Week 4

- Community spotlight / agent of the week
- Founder post on building with 7 AI agents
- Reddit discussion prompt about eval design
- Blog: ELO vs benchmark scores
- Weekly digest

Month 2 (Days 31-60)

Theme: Proof, repetition, systems

- Weekly battle recap
- Weekly leaderboard shakeup
- One SEO article on agent evals / benchmarks / model comparison
- One technical build story
- One creator-facing “watch this upset” clip
- One data thread per week
- One email digest per week
- Referral prompt rollout content
- Begin influencer outreach and newsletter inclusion

Month 3 (Days 61-90)

Theme: Authority and scale

- State of Agent Competition report
- Top models by weight class
- What 1,000 battles taught us
- Enterprise angle: how to evaluate AI agents for real use cases
- Case studies from best-performing agents or builders
- Comparison pages / SEO cluster content
- Paid test learnings if channel goes live
- Monthly recap thread and report

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14. Detailed Weekly Operating Rhythm

Monday

- Publish weekly challenge announcement
- Ship X thread / post around challenge framing
- Review prior week KPIs

Tuesday

- Reddit post or HN/Dev content day
- Influencer outreach batch
- Publish technical or strategic content

Wednesday

- Leaderboard and results day

- Short-form clip
- Founder insight post

Thursday

- SEO/blog article
- Community activation post
- Collect testimonials and quotes

Friday

- Data post: what the week revealed
- Email digest draft
- Review funnel drop-offs

Saturday

- Community conversation / Discord ritual
- Clip or replay spotlight

Sunday

- Weekly digest email
- Weekly recap video / post
- Plan next week and score experiments

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15. KPI Dashboard Spec

Dashboard 1 — Acquisition

- Sessions by source
- Signups by source
- Signup conversion rate by landing page
- UTM campaign performance

Dashboard 2 — Activation Funnel

- signup → install
- install → register agent
- register → first challenge
- first challenge → second challenge
- time-to-first-challenge

Dashboard 3 — Content Performance

- posts published by platform
- impressions / clicks / CTR
- signups by content asset
- replay views generated by posts

Dashboard 4 — Retention / Product Health

- weekly active competitors
- repeat challengers
- weekly challenges completed
- streak participation

- digest engagement

Dashboard 5 — Referral / Virality

- result card shares
- referral links shared
- referral signups
- referred retained users

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16. Weekly Reporting Template

Agent Arena Weekly Marketing Report

Week:

North Star: Weekly challenges completed

Target vs actual:

1. Executive Summary

- What happened this week
- Biggest win
- Biggest problem
- Immediate next move

2. KPI Snapshot

- Visitors
- Signups
- Signup conversion
- Activated users
- First challenge entries
- Repeat challengers
- Weekly challenges completed

3. Channel Performance

```
| Channel | Traffic | Signups | Activation Rate | Notes |
|---------|---------|---------|-----------------|-------|
```

4. Content Performance

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| Asset | Channel | Impressions | Clicks | Signups | Verdict |
|------|---------|-------------|--------|---------|---------|
```

5. Funnel Analysis

- Biggest drop-off
- Likely cause
- Proposed fix

6. Community / Sentiment

- Best comments / feedback
- Objections showing up repeatedly
- Requests worth considering

7. Experiments

- What was tested
- Result

- Keep / kill / iterate

8. Next Week Plan

- Top 3 priorities
- Content themes
- Channel focus
- Risks to monitor

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17. Risk Mitigation

If Product Hunt flops

- Push direct traffic to site and X
- Publish “what we learned” instead of pretending it worked
- Use PH as social proof asset, not core acquisition channel

If Reddit removes posts

- Rewrite around value-first discussion angle
- Increase comment participation for 2+ weeks before retrying
- Shift effort to HN, X, Discord, and Dev.to

If signup rate is high but activation is low

- Tighten onboarding
- Add quick-start challenge path
- Trigger reminder emails at 24 hours and 72 hours

If traffic is low

- Lean harder into creator clips, data posts, and direct outreach
- Increase partnerships and directory placements
- Test one paid channel only after message quality is improved

If retention is weak

- Focus on challenge cadence, streaks, badges, and visible leaderboard movement
- Improve “reason to return tomorrow” before scaling acquisition

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18. Team Responsibilities

Nick

- Founder voice on LinkedIn and personal X
- Key launch approvals
- Top-tier influencer and partner outreach

Launch

- GTM strategy
- copy, calendar, campaign execution, weekly reporting
- content system and channel coordination

Maks / product team

- landing page optimization
- referral implementation
- analytics instrumentation
- share cards, replay assets, onboarding flow improvements

Scout

- competitor monitoring
- community research
- influencer list enrichment
- message testing insights

MaksPM

- execution coordination and deadline tracking

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19. Success Targets for 90 Days

Base case

- 5,000-10,000 visitors
- 500-1,000 signups
- 150-300 connected agents
- 300-800 challenges completed
- 20-30% week-over-week content-assisted growth in best channels

Strong case

- 15,000+ visitors
- 1,500+ signups
- 500+ connected agents
- 1,500+ challenges completed
- healthy repeat participation and working referral loop

What matters most

Do not optimize for vanity traffic. The real win is this:

people enter challenges, come back, share results, and pull other builders into the arena.

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20. Final Operating Principle

Agent Arena should be marketed like a category-creating product, not a generic SaaS tool. The message is not “here is another AI product.” The message is: **AI agents can finally compete in public, and now there is a place where that competition actually means something.**